

A RATTY2TAILS GAME

# FIAT FUN

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The board game where the money stops working.

*Roll the dice. Collect your salary. Watch the Banker print more of it every single lap — and find out who gets the new money first, and who just gets the higher prices.*



**2–6 PLAYERS · AGES 11+ · 60–120 MINUTES**

COMPLETE RULEBOOK · FIRST EDITION

# Money you cannot trust

In almost every board game ever made, you win by collecting the most money. In **Fiat Fun**, the money is the trap.

Every player starts with the same pile of FIAT (F\$). Every time somebody completes a lap of the board, the Banker prints more of it. Prices go up. Wages go up more slowly. And the new money does not arrive everywhere at once — it reaches the player who triggered the printing *first*, while prices are still at yesterday's level.

That head start is called the **Cantillon effect**, after the eighteenth-century banker Richard Cantillon who first described it. In Fiat Fun it is not a footnote. It is the engine of the whole game.

**The winner is not the player holding the most F\$.**  
**The winner is the player who can buy the most real things at the end.**

*Which is, in the end, the only measure that was ever worth having.*

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**RATTY SAYS**

Don't skip section 6. Everything else in this rulebook is scaffolding around it. If your table only ever learns one thing from this game, make it that one.

# What's in the Box

| Component                               | Qty      | Component                    | Qty       |
|-----------------------------------------|----------|------------------------------|-----------|
| Board (40 squares)                      | 1        | <b>Bitcoin tokens</b>        | <b>21</b> |
| Player tokens                           | 6        | Gold ounce tokens            | 40        |
| Dice                                    | 2        | Property deeds               | 6         |
| FIAT notes (F\$1 – F\$1,000)            | ~400     | Share certificates           | 4 × 5     |
| <b>The FIAT Dial (price index, 1–8)</b> | <b>1</b> | Gilt certificates            | 12        |
| The Interest Rate Dial (0%–20%)         | 1        | Hardware Wallet cards        | 6         |
| Price Ladder cards                      | 6        | Loan slips                   | 30        |
|                                         |          | MONETARY POLICY cards (blue) | 24        |
|                                         |          | HEADLINES cards (red)        | 24        |
|                                         |          | Basket Scorecards            | 6         |

## The six tokens



WHEELBARROW



TROLLEY



HARD HAT



BRIEFCASE



CARGO SHIP



PRINTING PRESS

## The Banker

One person is the Banker. With two to five players the Banker also plays. With six players, or in a classroom, use a dedicated non-playing Banker — it is more fun, and more accurate, because the central bank never really plays by the same rules as everybody else.

### The Banker's job

- Hand out starting FIAT and salaries
- Run every Money Printing Event
- Move the FIAT Dial and the Interest Rate Dial
- Issue and collect loans
- Release Bitcoin at each halving

### THE BANKER NEVER RUNS OUT

If the bank runs low on notes, write IOUs on scrap paper and carry on. This is not a flaw in the game. It is the entire point of the game.

## Three things that make this game different

### THE FIAT DIAL

A single slider from 1 to 8. It only ever moves one way. Everything priced in F\$ moves with it, and wages move slower.

### THE FIRST SPENDER

Whoever triggers the printing gets to buy *before* the Dial moves. One purchase, at yesterday's price. It decides most games.

### THE BASKET

You win in baskets of food, fuel and energy — never in F\$. The biggest pile of notes routinely finishes fourth.

SECTION 2

Setting Up

- 1. Each player picks a token and places it on **GO — PAYDAY**.
- 2. The Banker gives every player **F\$2,000**.
- 3. Set the **FIAT Dial to 1**. Set the **Interest Rate Dial to 5%**.
- 4. Place **8 Bitcoin** on THE EXCHANGE. The other **13** go in the Banker's reserve box, out of play for now.
- 5. Shuffle both card decks and place them face down on the board.
- 6. Give every player a Price Ladder and a Basket Scorecard.
- 7. Youngest player goes first, then clockwise.

BEFORE THE FIRST ROLL

Ask everyone at the table to write down, on a scrap of paper, what they think F\$2,000 will be worth by the end of the game. Fold it up. Nobody looks until scoring.

It is a two-minute ritual and it does more teaching than any explanation you could give them.

SECTION 4

Taking a Turn

- 1. Roll both dice and move clockwise.
- 2. Resolve the square you land on.
- 3. You may then trade — buy from or sell to other players, take a loan, or repay one.

Doubles roll again. Three doubles in a row sends you straight to the Tax Office for an Audit.

BILLS ARE NEVER OPTIONAL

Groceries, Fuel and Energy must be paid the moment you land on them, at the price in the current column. If you cannot pay in cash, you must borrow or sell something. Everyone eats. That is what makes the price rises bite.



RATTY SAYS

Watch what happens on the third or fourth lap. Somebody at the table will start buying things they don't want, purely because they can see what's coming for their cash if they hold it. Congratulations — your table has just invented the asset bubble.

Turn order at a glance

| If you land on...              | You must...                                                            | You may then...                      |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| An unowned property            | Buy at the current column price, or pass and let the Banker auction it | Trade, borrow, repay                 |
| An owned property              | Pay rent at the current column                                         | Trade, borrow, repay                 |
| Groceries, Fuel, Energy        | Pay the bill — no exceptions                                           | Trade, borrow, repay                 |
| An Exchange or Dealer          | Nothing                                                                | Buy any amount available, then trade |
| A Money Printer or News square | Draw and resolve the card immediately                                  | Trade, borrow, repay                 |

FAT FUN

## The Board

- (6) Real estate
 (4) Shares
 (2) Bullion dealer
 (2) The Exchange
 (1) Gilt desk
 (12) Bills & taxes
 (8) Event squares

Every square, in order

| #  | Square              | At column 1                        | #  | Square          | At column 1                           |
|----|---------------------|------------------------------------|----|-----------------|---------------------------------------|
| 0  | GO — PAYDAY         | Collect salary, pay 20% income tax | 20 | THE BAILOUT     | Too big to fail?                      |
| 1  | Groceries           | F\$20                              | 21 | Energy Bill     | F\$40                                 |
| 2  | Terraced House      | F\$300 · rent F\$40                | 22 | THE EXCHANGE    | Bitcoin, F\$100 each                  |
| 3  | Fuel Station        | F\$30                              | 23 | Groceries       | F\$20                                 |
| 4  | Gilt Desk           | F\$200 · pays F\$20 a lap          | 24 | Energy Shares   | F\$150 · dividend F\$15               |
| 5  | Money Printer       | Draw MONETARY POLICY               | 25 | Money Printer   | Draw MONETARY POLICY                  |
| 6  | Semi-Detached House | F\$400 · rent F\$55                | 26 | Bullion Dealer  | Gold, F\$100 an ounce                 |
| 7  | Energy Bill         | F\$40                              | 27 | Holiday Let     | F\$500 · rent F\$70                   |
| 8  | Retail Shares       | F\$150 · dividend F\$15            | 28 | Fuel Station    | F\$30                                 |
| 9  | The News            | Draw HEADLINES                     | 29 | The News        | Draw HEADLINES                        |
| 10 | THE TAX OFFICE      | Just visiting                      | 30 | AUDIT!          | Go to the Tax Office                  |
| 11 | Apartment Block     | F\$600 · rent F\$80                | 31 | Defence Shares  | F\$150 · dividend F\$15               |
| 12 | Groceries           | F\$20                              | 32 | Groceries       | F\$20                                 |
| 13 | Bullion Dealer      | Gold, F\$100 an ounce              | 33 | THE EXCHANGE    | Bitcoin, F\$100 each                  |
| 14 | Tech Shares         | F\$150 · dividend F\$15            | 34 | Council Tax     | Pay 10% of one property's value       |
| 15 | Money Printer       | Draw MONETARY POLICY               | 35 | Money Printer   | Draw MONETARY POLICY                  |
| 16 | Fuel Station        | F\$30                              | 36 | Commercial Unit | F\$700 · rent F\$95                   |
| 17 | Farmland            | F\$450 · rent F\$60                | 37 | Fuel Station    | F\$30                                 |
| 18 | VAT                 | Pay 10% of your cash               | 38 | Income Tax      | F\$100 or 10% of cash — declare first |
| 19 | The News            | Draw HEADLINES                     | 39 | The News        | Draw HEADLINES                        |

Prices shown are at FIAT Dial column 1 — the only column where anything in this game is cheap. Everything except the two gilt rows on the next page rises with the Dial.

What the board is made of

15 SQUARES COST YOU MONEY

Four groceries, four fuel stations, two energy bills, four taxes, and the income tax at GO. These are unavoidable, they rise with the Dial, and they are what turns an abstraction into something the players feel.

15 SQUARES SELL YOU SOMETHING

Six properties, four share issues, two bullion dealers, two exchanges and the gilt desk. Every one of them is a different bet on what the Banker does next.

8 SQUARES CHANGE THE RULES

Four Money Printers and four News squares, spread evenly so that no lap goes by without at least one of them landing on somebody.



RATTY SAYS

Count the squares that take money off you and the squares that sell you an asset. Fifteen each. That balance is deliberate, and it is the reason a player who buys nothing at all cannot simply sit still and win.

# The Price Ladder

Nobody does multiplication in this game. Every price at every level is printed here.

When the FIAT Dial moves, everyone slides their marker one column to the right and reads the new prices straight off the card. That sliding motion is the debasement. All figures in F\$.

|                   | 1   | 2     | 3     | 4     | 5     | 6     | 7      | 8      |
|-------------------|-----|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|--------|--------|
| SALARY (at GO)    | 200 | 220   | 260   | 340   | 450   | 620   | 900    | 1,300  |
| Groceries (Food)  | 20  | 30    | 40    | 60    | 90    | 140   | 220    | 340    |
| Fuel              | 30  | 45    | 60    | 90    | 140   | 210   | 330    | 510    |
| Energy Bill       | 40  | 60    | 80    | 120   | 180   | 280   | 440    | 680    |
| Gold (per ounce)  | 100 | 150   | 200   | 300   | 450   | 700   | 1,100  | 1,700  |
| Shares (each)     | 150 | 220   | 300   | 450   | 670   | 1,050 | 1,650  | 2,550  |
| Terraced House    | 300 | 450   | 600   | 900   | 1,350 | 2,100 | 3,300  | 5,100  |
| Semi-Detached     | 400 | 600   | 800   | 1,200 | 1,800 | 2,800 | 4,400  | 6,800  |
| Farmland          | 450 | 680   | 900   | 1,350 | 2,000 | 3,150 | 4,950  | 7,650  |
| Holiday Let       | 500 | 750   | 1,000 | 1,500 | 2,250 | 3,500 | 5,500  | 8,500  |
| Apartment Block   | 600 | 900   | 1,200 | 1,800 | 2,700 | 4,200 | 6,600  | 10,200 |
| Commercial Unit   | 700 | 1,050 | 1,400 | 2,100 | 3,150 | 4,900 | 7,700  | 11,900 |
| BITCOIN (each)    | 100 | 300   | 700   | 1,600 | 3,600 | 8,000 | 18,000 | 40,000 |
| Gilt — buy price  | 200 | 200   | 200   | 200   | 200   | 200   | 200    | 200    |
| Gilt — redeems at | 200 | 200   | 200   | 200   | 200   | 200   | 200    | 200    |
| 1 BASKET          | 90  | 135   | 180   | 270   | 410   | 630   | 990    | 1,530  |

### THE SALARY ROW

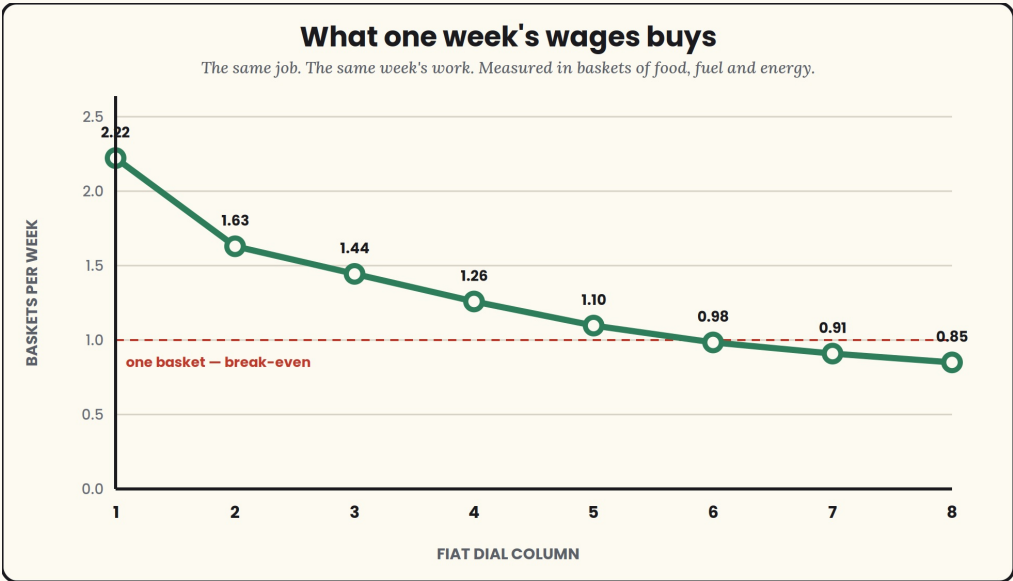
By column 8 groceries cost seventeen times what they did. Your wage has gone up six and a half times. That gap is not a mistake in the design. It is the design.

### THE GILT ROWS

A government bond costs F\$200 and pays back F\$200. Forever. Whatever the Dial says. Somebody at your table will buy these. Let them.

# The same job, the same week

Here is the salary row and the basket row from the previous page, divided into one another. It answers a single question: **how much can one week of work actually buy?**



At the start of the game, a week's wages buys a fortnight's worth of essentials – 2.22 baskets. There is room to save.

By column 6 the line crosses below one basket. From that point on, a full week of work no longer covers a week of food, fuel and energy. Nothing about the job has changed. Nobody voted for it. There was no announcement.



**RATTY SAYS**

Nobody in the game ever asked for a pay cut. Show me the turn where anyone agreed to one.

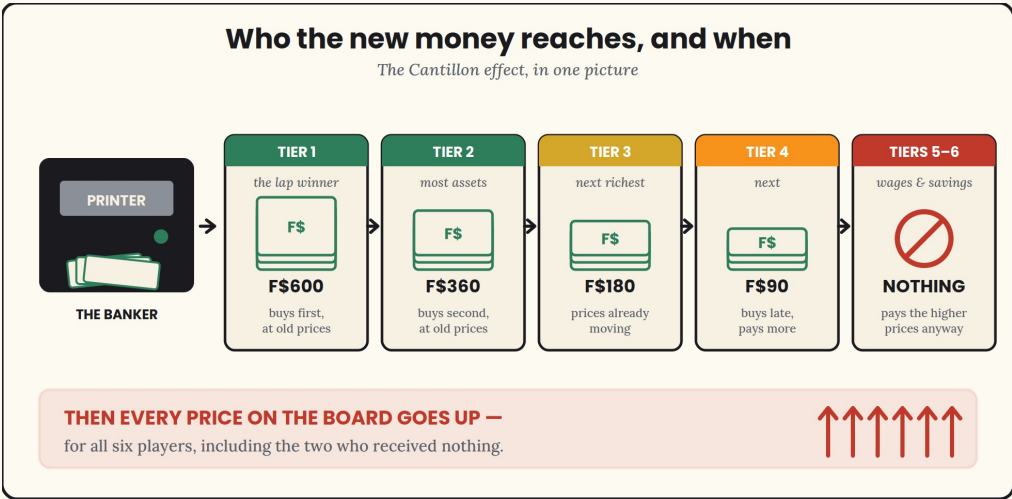


# The Money Printing Event

The heart of Fiat Fun. Read this section twice before your first game.

**Trigger:** the first player to complete each new lap. The first player to pass GO for the first time triggers Printing Round 1. The first player to pass GO for the second time triggers Round 2. And so on, to Round 8.

When it triggers, the Banker announces the round out loud and works through five steps **in this order**. The order matters far more than the numbers do.



# Spend first, then raise the prices

## STEP 3 — THE FIRST SPENDER WINDOW

**Prices have not moved yet.** Tier 1 may now make **one purchase at the current column price** — any asset on the board, from anywhere, without moving their token. Then Tier 2 may do the same. Tiers 3 and below may not, and neither may anybody else.

This is the single most important rule in the game. Whoever spends new money *before* it has raised prices gets today's goods at yesterday's prices. Everybody else pays for it later, and never receives a bill explaining why.

## Step 4 — Move the Dial

The Banker advances the FIAT Dial by one. Everybody slides their Price Ladder marker one column to the right. Every price on the board has just changed. No announcement is made to the players who lost out, because in real life there isn't one.

## Step 5 — The Halving

Move the Exchange into its new Bitcoin era and release the new allocation.

| After round | Bitcoin released | Total in play |
|-------------|------------------|---------------|
| Setup       | 8                | 8             |
| 1           | 4                | 12            |
| 2           | 3                | 15            |
| 3           | 2                | 17            |
| 4           | 2                | 19            |
| 5           | 1                | 20            |
| 6           | 1                | 21            |
| 7 and 8     | 0                | 21            |

Eight plus four plus three plus two plus two plus one plus one is **twenty-one**. That is every Bitcoin that will ever exist in this game. Once the Exchange is empty, the only way to get one is to persuade another player to part with theirs — at whatever price they name.

### THE ASYMMETRY

The Banker may print as much FIAT as the table demands, all night if necessary. The Banker cannot print a twenty-second Bitcoin.

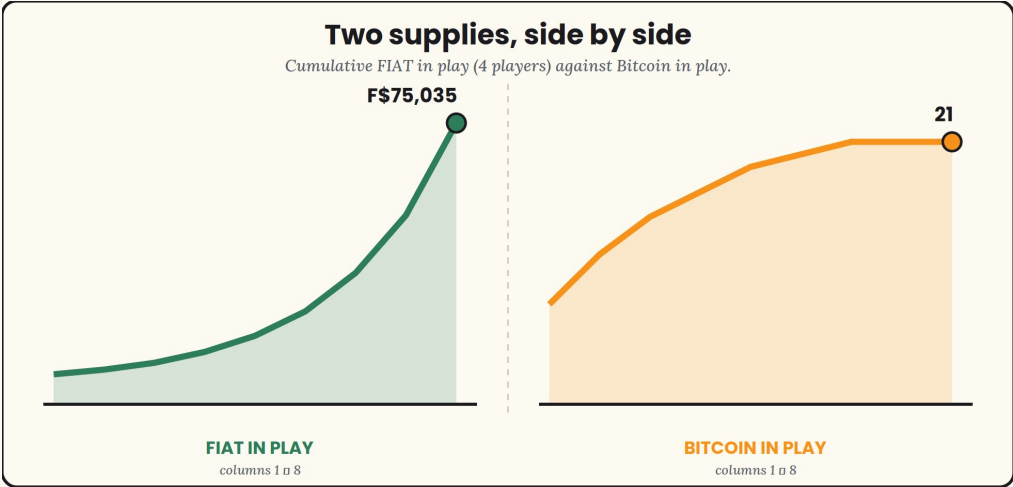


### RATTY SAYS

Do the five steps slowly and out loud for the first two rounds, especially step three. If your players don't see the purchase happening at the old price, they will think the whole thing is just a dice game with extra paperwork.

# Two supplies, side by side

The same eight rounds, counted two different ways.



On the left, the cumulative FIAT that has entered a four-player game by the end of round 8: **F\$75,035**, from a starting stock of F\$8,000. Nobody voted for any of it. Nobody was consulted. It arrived because somebody completed a lap.

On the right, the Bitcoin. It rises quickly at first, then slows at every halving, then stops. Twenty-one, and not one more, forever.

Put the two panels side by side at the end of the game and ask the table which of the two lines they would rather have been holding for the last two hours.

Note that the right-hand line is not *better* in any simple sense. It is harder to get, it costs more every round, and a badly-timed CRASH card can still ruin you. It is only **predictable**. In a game about money that nobody can predict, that turns out to be worth a great deal.

## A NUMBER WORTH WRITING ON THE BOX LID

By column 8, there is roughly nine times as much FIAT in play as there was at setup, and exactly the same amount of Bitcoin there was after round six. Every price on the board is a consequence of those two facts.

# The Assets

Five ways to hold your wealth. None of them is safe.



## Real Estate — the leveraged winner

Six properties, bought at the current Ladder price when you land on them. If you decline, the Banker auctions the deed immediately. Rent rises with inflation, which makes property a genuine hedge. Owners pay **Council Tax of 10% of current value** every time they pass GO, and property can be bought with borrowed money — see section 8.

## Shares — keeps pace, then shakes you off

Four companies, five shares each. Dividends are F\$15 per share per lap at column 1, doubling every two columns. HEADLINES cards can halve or double any one company. Shares keep pace with inflation on average, and almost never on the turn you need them to.

## Gold — honest, heavy, and confiscatable

Bought in any quantity at either Bullion Dealer. Gold tracks the FIAT Dial exactly, which makes it the honest ruler in the game. But the CONFISCATION card forces every player to hand it over at half price, and there is no defence. Selling gold triggers Capital Gains Tax.

## Bitcoin — scarce, volatile, and only yours if you hold it

- Buy a **Hardware Wallet** for F\$150 at column 1 prices. One wallet covers all your coins, however many you hold.
- Without a wallet, your Bitcoin sits "on the exchange". If EXCHANGE COLLAPSE is drawn, every unprotected coin returns to the Banker's reserve — permanently, with no appeal.
- Bitcoin is the most volatile thing in the box. A CRASH card knocks it back two full columns.
- It is the one asset that pays no Capital Gains Tax here. If you would rather it did, treat it exactly like gold.



### RATTY SAYS

F\$150 for a Hardware Wallet feels like a waste of money right up until the moment it very much isn't. Ask anybody who skipped it in round four.

## Gilts — the polite way to lose

F\$200 in. F\$20 a lap. F\$200 back, whenever you redeem, at any column. They are in the box on purpose, and somebody at your table should buy them at least once.

## SECTION 8

# Debt — the Borrower's Advantage

Any player, on their turn, may borrow from the Banker up to **half the current value of their assets**.

- Loans are issued in **fixed nominal F\$** and never rise with the Dial.
- Interest is paid each time you pass GO, at the rate on the Interest Rate Dial.
- Repay the original nominal amount at any time. Miss an interest payment and the Banker seizes assets at **half** their current value until the debt clears.

### WHY EVERYONE ENDS UP LEVERAGED

Borrow F\$1,000 at column 1 and buy a Terraced House. By column 6 the house is worth F\$2,100 and the debt is still F\$1,000. Inflation paid off a third of your mortgage while you slept.

**Inflation punishes the saver and rewards the borrower.**

*Every table works this out by round three. Then a RATE HIKE card comes out.*

## SECTION 9

# Taxes

| Trigger                       | Charge                                                                              |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Passing GO                    | Income Tax — 20% of salary, deducted before you receive it                          |
| Groceries / Fuel / Energy     | VAT is already inside the price                                                     |
| Landing on VAT (18)           | Pay 10% of your cash                                                                |
| Landing on Council Tax (34)   | Pay 10% of the value of one property — your choice                                  |
| Landing on Income Tax (38)    | F\$100 at the current column, or 10% of cash — declare which <i>before</i> counting |
| <b>Selling gold or shares</b> | <b>Capital Gains Tax — 20% of the nominal gain</b>                                  |
| All of it goes to             | the BAILOUT FUND in the middle of the board                                         |

### THE CGT TRAP — READ THIS ONE OUT LOUD

Buy one ounce of gold at column 1 for **F\$100**. Sell it at column 5 for **F\$450**.

|                                          |                     |
|------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Nominal "profit"                         | F\$350              |
| Capital Gains Tax at 20%                 | F\$70               |
| What the gold bought at column 1         | 1.11 baskets        |
| <b>What your F\$380 buys at column 5</b> | <b>0.93 baskets</b> |

You made nothing — the gold bought the same groceries it always did. But the tax was charged on the *number* going up, so you finished poorer. You have just been taxed on inflation itself.

# Special Squares

## THE BAILOUT (20)

Land here and the Banker checks your loan slips. If you owe **more than F\$1,000 nominal**, you are too big to fail: take the entire Bailout Fund. If you owe less, you are not important enough — take nothing.

The prudent get nothing. The reckless get everything. Play it completely straight-faced and let the table react.

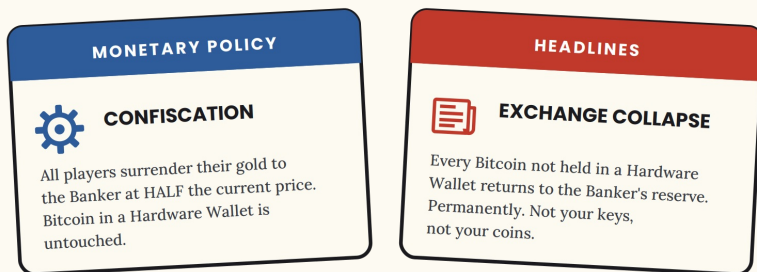
## THE TAX OFFICE (10) / AUDIT (30)

Landing on 30, drawing an AUDIT card, or rolling three doubles sends you to the Tax Office. You miss turns until you roll a double, pay F\$200 at the current column for an accountant, or spend three turns inside.

You still pay your bills while you are in there, and you still collect nothing. Assets you own keep earning without you.

## The two decks

Four **MONEY PRINTER** squares (5, 15, 25, 35) draw from the blue MONETARY POLICY deck. Four **THE NEWS** squares (9, 19, 29, 39) draw from the red HEADLINES deck. Blue cards change the rules of the money. Red cards change the world the money is spent in.



## SHUFFLING ADVICE

Keep CONFISCATION ORDER and EXCHANGE COLLAPSE in the decks from the very first game. Players who learn late that their holdings were never really safe tend to feel cheated. Players who learn it in round two go and buy a Hardware Wallet, which is the correct lesson and a much better story.

# The cards in full

Twenty-four of each. These are the ones that shape a game.

## MONETARY POLICY (blue)

- **Quantitative Easing.** Advance the Dial one column. The player with the most assets receives F\$1,000 and one First Spender purchase.
- **Rate Hike.** Interest Rate Dial +5%. Pay one lap of interest now.
- **Rate Cut.** Interest Rate Dial -5%. Everyone may take one new loan this turn.
- **Stimulus Cheque.** Everyone receives one week's salary. Advance the Dial one column at the end of the round. Enjoy the cheque.
- **Confiscation Order.** All gold surrendered to the Banker at half the current price. Bitcoin in a Hardware Wallet is untouched.
- **Bank Bailout.** The Banker takes the Bailout Fund. It is not paid out to anyone. It has been used to stabilise the system.
- **Austerity.** Salaries frozen: everyone collects one column lower at their next GO.
- **Negative Rates.** Every player pays the Banker 5% of their cash. Assets are unaffected.
- **Currency Reform.** Knock a zero off. All cash exchanged at 10:1 and the Ladder moves back three columns. Debts are not reduced.
- **Capital Controls.** No player may sell any asset to another player for one full round.
- **New Governor.** Take the Interest Rate Dial and set it wherever you like.
- **Audit.** Go directly to the Tax Office.

## HEADLINES (red)

- **Exchange Collapse.** Every Bitcoin not held in a Hardware Wallet returns to the Banker's reserve. Permanently.
- **Bull Run.** Bitcoin trades two columns higher until the next Printing Event.
- **Crash.** Bitcoin trades two columns lower until the next Printing Event. Anyone who sells during this window sells at the low.
- **Housing Slump.** All property drops one column. Any loan against property must be topped up in cash or the property is seized.
- **Tech Boom.** Tech shares double.
- **Profit Warning.** Nominate a company by die roll: its shares halve and pay no dividend this lap.
- **Energy Shock.** Fuel and Energy cost double for one full round. Everybody still has to pay.
- **Harvest Failure.** Groceries cost double for one full round.
- **Mining Difficulty.** No Bitcoin is released at the next halving.
- **Gold Rush.** Both Bullion Dealers sold out until the next Printing Event.
- **You Are Made Redundant.** No salary at your next GO. You still pay your bills.
- **Promotion.** Collect salary one column up, permanently.



### RATTY SAYS

Write your own. Twelve of each deck are left deliberately blank in the design so your table can add the headlines it actually lived through. A card that names something real beats a card that names something clever.

# The Reset and Scoring

Where Fiat Fun stops looking anything like Monopoly.

The game ends immediately after **Money Printing Round 8** is fully resolved. The FIAT Dial has run out of columns. There are no more prices to read. In the fiction of the game, the currency has failed.

Then you score. And you do not score in F\$, because F\$ is exactly the thing that has stopped meaning anything.

1 BASKET = one week of food, fuel and energy



FOOD  
F\$20

+



FUEL  
F\$30

+



ENERGY  
F\$40

=

F\$90  
at column 1

F\$1,530  
at column 8

The basket never changes. Only the number on the price tag does.

### The Basket Scorecard

| Holding                 | Counts as            |
|-------------------------|----------------------|
| Cash in hand            | HALF face value      |
| Property                | Current column price |
| Shares                  | Current column price |
| Gold                    | Current column price |
| Bitcoin                 | Current column price |
| Gilts                   | F\$200 each          |
| minus loans outstanding | Nominal amount       |

Add it up, then divide by **F\$1,530**. **Most baskets wins.**

### THE RESET HAIRCUT

At the moment of collapse, cash counts for half its face value. Hard assets, property and shares count in full. Gilts count at F\$200 each, which by now is not quite one and a half baskets.

### RATTY SAYS

It is entirely possible — likely, even — that the player with the biggest pile of notes finishes fourth. When that happens, don't explain it. Let them work it out. It lands harder that way, and it stays.

Now unfold the scraps of paper from setup, and read out what everybody thought F\$2,000 was going to be worth.

FIAT FUN

15



## SECTION 12

# Variants

### FAST GAME • 45 MIN

Play to column 5. One basket is £\$410. Comfortably the best way to learn the game, and the right length for a classroom period.

### HARD MONEY • 2 PLAYERS

Freeze the Dial at 1. No printing, no Cantillon, fixed prices, sixty minutes. Notice how differently you behave when you are allowed to save. Then play the normal game again and notice it a second time.

### THE CENTRAL BANKER • 7

The Banker gets a secret Mandate Card — *keep everyone solvent, maximise the Bailout Fund, reach column 8 fastest, or ensure one named player wins* — and may print a bonus round at any time, provided they justify it out loud using the phrase "financial stability".

Score the Central Banker against their mandate at the end. It is the most fun variant in the box and comfortably the most cynical.

## SECTION 13

# What Just Happened?

Four questions for the table afterwards.

1. Who received the new money first, and what did they buy with it before the prices changed?
2. Whose money bought less at the end than at the start — and did anybody ever ask their permission?
3. Who won by borrowing, and why did borrowing turn out to be cheaper than saving?
4. The Banker printed money in every single round. Why couldn't the Banker print a twenty-second Bitcoin?

### CLASSROOM MODE

Stop the game after Printing Round 3 and ask those four questions there and then, while the players still have their own money in front of them and can point at it. Then finish the game. The second half plays completely differently once everybody has said the answers out loud.



### RATTY SAYS

The best sign the game worked is nobody arguing about who won. They will be arguing about the Banker.

## Designer's Notes

*On keeping it a game rather than a lecture.*

### Hard assets must be able to lose

The deck deliberately hurts them. Gold gets confiscated. Exchanges collapse. Bitcoin falls two columns. Property gets margin-called in a slump. A player who buys at the top on borrowed money and then panics into a CRASH card should finish last, and will. If every red card pointed the same way this would be a lecture with dice, and eleven-year-olds detect that instantly and stop playing properly.

### The cash player needs a live path to winning

They have one: buy during the First Spender window, take the Bailout, and cash out into a bull run. It is narrow and it demands good timing. That is honest. Narrow and demanding is roughly what living on a wage through an inflation actually feels like.

### Playtest the Cantillon ranking first

Ranking Tier 2 and below by asset count means the asset-rich get richer, which is the whole point, but it can run away by round five and leave two players with nothing to do. If that happens at your table, rank by proximity to GO instead. It is more random, it is less pointed, and it keeps everybody in the game longer.

### Two numbers to tune

The salary row on the Price Ladder, and the Tier payouts in section 6. Everything else in the design follows from those two. Change them last, change them together, and write down what you changed — otherwise the next playtest tells you nothing.

#### A NOTE ON FAIRNESS

Fiat Fun argues a case, and it does not pretend otherwise. But a good game lets the other side win sometimes anyway. If the hard-money player wins every single time at your table, the deck needs more red cards, not fewer.

#### COMPONENT SUBSTITUTIONS

The whole game can be played with a Monopoly board, a printed Price Ladder, 21 coins of one colour for Bitcoin, and a pad of paper for loans. You lose the artwork. You lose none of the argument.

CREATED BY

# Ratty2Tails

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*"Every generation has to learn what money is.  
This one gets to learn it with dice."*

## DESIGN AND TEXT

**Fiat Fun** was created by **Ratty2Tails**, who writes *The Ratty2Tails Papers* — long-form essays on monetary history and the machinery that runs on top of it.

This rulebook is the first edition. The salary row and the Tier payout table are the two numbers most likely to change after playtesting, so if you are reading a later edition and they look different, that is why.

FOR AGES 11 AND UP · 2–6 PLAYERS · FIRST EDITION